

PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING MODULE



Recognize phishing emails and fake websites. Understand social engineering.
Practice safe response habits.

Prepared by: Keerit Kapoor
Date: June 2026

Learning goals

By the end, the viewer can spot, avoid, and report phishing attempts.

1. Spot red flags

Sender spoofing
Urgent threats
Suspicious links
Unexpected attachments

2. Verify safely

Use official websites
Avoid email links
Enable MFA
Report suspicious emails

3. Practice decisions

Classify examples as:
Safe
Suspicious
Phishing
Then explain why

This module includes simulated examples, quick checks, and a short quiz.

What phishing is

Phishing uses deception to trick people into sharing information, clicking links, or opening malware.

Phishing is a social-engineering attack: the attacker pretends to be trusted so the victim acts quickly.

Common channels: email, SMS, calls, fake websites, and social media messages.

Common goals: steal passwords, capture OTPs, collect payment details, or install malware.

Main tactic: make the request feel urgent, familiar, or official.

Attacker formula

**Trust
+
Urgency
+
Action link
=
Risk**

Email examples: safe vs suspicious vs phishing

All examples are simulated for training and contain no real links or accounts.

SIMULATED TRAINING EMAILS – No real accounts, links, or credentials used

These are examples created for educational purposes to demonstrate how to identify safe, suspicious, and phishing emails.

SAFE vs SUSPICIOUS vs PHISHING

1. SAFE EMAIL

From: orders@northstar.example
To: keerit.kapoor@example.com
Subject: Your NorthStar Order Confirmation
Date: 20 June 2026, 10:30 AM

NORTHSTAR

Hi Keerit Kapoor,

Thank you for your order with NorthStar!

Your order #NS-58921 has been confirmed and will be delivered on 24 June 2026.

You can view your order details by logging in to your account on [our website](#).

If you have any questions, feel free to contact our support team.

Thank you,
NorthStar Orders Team

This email is from the official domain, personalized, and contains no urgent requests or suspicious links.

2. SUSPICIOUS EMAIL

From: support@northstar-security.example
To: keerit.kapoor@example.com
Subject: Important: Verify Your Account
Date: 20 June 2026, 02:15 PM

NORTHSTAR

Dear Customer,

We detected unusual activity on your account. Please verify your account to avoid restrictions.

[Verify Your Account](#)

<https://northstar-security.example/verify>

If you do not verify, your account may be limited.

Thank you,
NorthStar Security Team

The sender uses a lookalike domain (northstar-security.example) and creates a sense of urgency to prompt action.

3. PHISHING EMAIL

From: secure-update@payment-alert.example
To: keerit.kapoor@example.com
Subject: Urgent: Payment Failed – Action Required
Date: 20 June 2026, 06:45 PM

URGENT ACTION REQUIRED

Dear Customer,

We were unable to process your payment. Your account will be suspended within 24 hours if you do not update your payment details.

[Update Payment Now](#)

<http://payment-alert.example/update>

Failure to act will result in permanent account suspension.

Thank you,
Payment Alerts Team

Unrelated domain, urgent/threatening language, requests immediate action, and uses a suspicious link.

QUICK COMPARISON

Indicator	Safe Email	Suspicious Email	Phishing Email
Sender Domain	Matches official brand domain	Lookalike domain	Unrelated / fake domain
Greeting	Personalized	Generic	Generic
Language / Tone	Professional, Informative	Cautious, Creates urgency	Urgent, Threatening
Links	Links to official website (no direct login)	Redirects to lookalike site	Suspicious link to fake site
Request for Sensitive Info	No	Implicit (verify account)	Yes (update payment details)
Overall Classification	SAFE	SUSPICIOUS	PHISHING

Always think before you click. When in doubt, verify the sender, check the full email address, hover over links, and contact the organization using official channels.

Be Aware. Be Secure.

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship | Phishing Awareness Training | Keerit Kapoor

04

Email red flags to check

Do not trust the display name alone. Read the full email address and the message behavior.



PHISHING INDICATOR ANALYSIS

SIMULATED TRAINING ANALYSIS — No real accounts, links, or credentials used



Indicator	 SAFE EMAIL	 SUSPICIOUS EMAIL	 PHISHING EMAIL
 1. Sender Domain	Matches official brand domain	Lookalike / extra-word domain	Fake or unrelated domain
 2. Greeting	Personalized	Generic	Generic
 3. Tone	Professional and informative	Creates caution / mild urgency	Threatening / highly urgent
 4. Link Behavior	Official website or no action link	Requests verification via lookalike site	Pushes suspicious action link
 5. Request for Sensitive Info	No	Implicit request	Yes
 6. Pressure / Deadline	None	Limited time pressure	Immediate deadline / account threat
 7. Overall Classification	 SAFE	 SUSPICIOUS	 PHISHING



HOW TO ANALYZE AN EMAIL

-  Check the full sender address
-  Read the tone and urgency
-  Hover over links before clicking
-  Look for requests for passwords, OTPs, or payment details
-  Verify through official channels



 Phishing attacks rely on urgency and deception. Stay alert, verify details, and protect your data.

 Prepared by: Keerit Kapoor

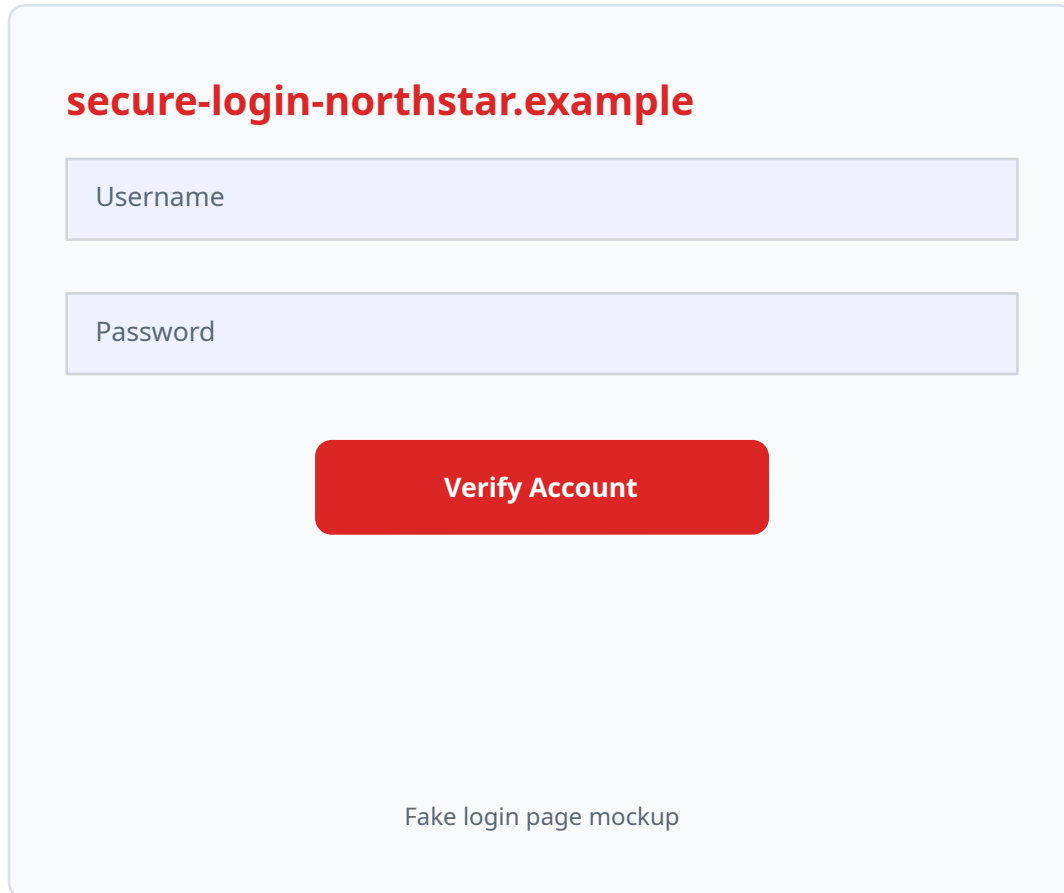
Future Interns Cyber Security Internship

Date: 20 June 2026

 Be Aware. Be Secure.

Fake website warning signs

A phishing email often sends victims to a fake page that imitates a real brand.



The mockup shows a light gray rectangular box representing a web page. At the top left, the text 'secure-login-northstar.example' is displayed in red. Below this, there are two light blue input fields. The first field is labeled 'Username' and the second is labeled 'Password'. Centered below these fields is a red button with the white text 'Verify Account'. At the bottom center of the gray box, the text 'Fake login page mockup' is written in a small, gray font.

Warning signs

The domain is slightly different from the real website.

The page asks for passwords or OTPs after an unexpected email.

The page uses pressure: “verify now” or “account blocked”.

The safest route is to type the official website manually.

Rule: If the message is unexpected, do not use its link. Open the official website or app directly.

Social-engineering tactics

Attackers target human reactions: fear, curiosity, authority, and reward.



Fear

"Your account will be suspended"



Authority

"From IT / bank / admin"



Curiosity

"See attached invoice"



Reward

"You won a gift card"

Defence habit: pause, verify through a separate trusted channel, and report suspicious messages.

Best practices to avoid phishing

Use this simple process before clicking, downloading, or replying.

- 1 Check sender** Verify the full email address and domain.
- 2 Inspect links** Hover first. Do not click unexpected links.
- 3 Protect credentials** Never share passwords, OTPs, or card details by email.
- 4 Use MFA** Enable multi-factor authentication wherever possible.
- 5 Report** Use your email provider or IT/security reporting channel.

Quick rule: When in doubt, do not click. Verify through an official website, app, or phone number you already trust.

Interactive quiz

Pause the video and answer before revealing the answers on the next slide.

Q1

An email says your account closes in 2 hours unless you click a link. What is the safest action?

A) Click quickly B) Verify through the official website C) Reply with your password

Q2

The display name says “Bank Support,” but the sender domain is bank-security-login.example. What is the red flag?

A) Lookalike domain B) Too much punctuation C) The time of day

Q3

A message asks for your OTP to “complete verification.” What should you do?

A) Send it B) Ask a friend C) Never share OTPs by email

Quiz answers + closing

- Q1** B - Verify through the official website or app.
- Q2** A - The sender uses a lookalike domain.
- Q3** C - Never share OTPs, passwords, or payment data by email.

Remember: Stop. Check. Verify. Report.

References: CISA Recognize and Report Phishing; FTC How to Recognize and Avoid Phishing Scams; CISA Avoiding Social Engineering and Phishing Attacks; FBI Spoofing and Phishing.